Past simple: *be*: Activity 1

Read Grammar bank 10B. Write sentences or questions with *was* or *were*. Use contractions. Listen and check.

Grammar bank

10B past simple: *be*

[+]
I was at home at 8.00 pm.
You were in class yesterday.
He was tired last night.
It was hot last week.
We were in London last month.
You were late this morning.
They were famous in the 60s.

[–]
I wasn't at home. (*wasn't = was not*)
You weren't in class yesterday. (*weren't = were not*)
He wasn't tired last night.
It wasn't hot last week.
We weren't in London last month.
You weren't late this morning.
They weren't famous in the 60s.

[?] [+] [–]
Were you late? Yes, **I was**. No, **I wasn't**.
Was she a singer? Yes, **she was**. No, **she wasn't**.
Were they in Mexico last week? Yes, **they were**. No, **they weren't**.

• We use *was* / *were* to talk about the past.
• Present to past: *am* / *is* → *was*, *are* → *were*
He is at home today.
He was at home yesterday.
• The past of *there is* = *there was*, and the past of *there are* = *there were*.
There was a party at the school last night.

Past time expressions

You can use the past simple with these time expressions:
this morning, yesterday, last night, last week, last month, last year
He was late for work this morning.
She wasn't in class last week.

1 you (?)
_____ at school yesterday?
2 James (–)
_____ well yesterday.
3 We (+)
_____ on the plane at 4.00.



Activity 1.MP3

4 they (?)
_____ in class yesterday?
5 You (–)
_____ very hungry this morning.
6 I (+)
_____ in a meeting until 7.00 last night.
7 your sister (?)
_____ sister in London last week?
8 It (+)
_____ a terrible film.
9 You (–)
_____ at home last weekend.
10 Sarah and Emma (+)
_____ tired this morning.

Past simple: *be*: Activity 2

Read Grammar bank 10B. Complete the conversations with *was*, *wasn't*, *were*, or *weren't*. Listen and check.

Grammar bank

10B past simple: *be*

[+]
I was at home at 8.00 pm.
You were in class yesterday.
He was tired last night.
It was hot last week.
We were in London last month.
You were late this morning.
They were famous in the 60s.

[-]
I wasn't at home. (*wasn't = was not*)
You weren't in class yesterday. (*weren't = were not*)
He wasn't tired last night.
It wasn't hot last week.
We weren't in London last month.
You weren't late this morning.
They weren't famous in the 60s.

[?] [+] [-]
Were you late? Yes, **I was**. No, **I wasn't**.
Was she a singer? Yes, **she was**. No, **she wasn't**.
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• We use *was* / *were* to talk about the past.
• Present to past: *am* / *is* → *was*, *are* → *were*
He is at home today.
He was at home yesterday.

• The past of *there is = there was*, and the past of *there are = there were*.
There was a party at the school last night.

Past time expressions

You can use the past simple with these time expressions:
this morning, yesterday, last night, last week, last month, last year
He was late for work this morning.
She wasn't in class last week.

1
A Where were you last night?
B I _____ at work all evening.
A No, you _____ . You _____ with Miriam.
B No, I _____ !

2
A _____ Freddie Mercury an actor?
B No, he _____ . He _____ a singer with Queen.

3
A _____ you in Milan yesterday?
B No, we _____ . We _____ in Rome.

4
A _____ the film good?
B No, it _____ . It _____ very slow!



Activity 2.MP3

in, on, at

Where were you yesterday at 7pm? Match the words and phrases to *at*, *in* or *on*. Listen and check.

my car a plane work a restaurant school

a train bed a shopping centre the park a pub

university a bus the street home the kitchen

London a museum



Activity.MP3

at	in	on

Sentence rhythm

Listen. Then say and record. Copy the rhythm.

1.**Where** were you at **seven** o'**clock yesterday** morning?	1.mp3
2.I was at **home**.	2.mp3
3.Were you in **bed**?	3.mp3
4.**Yes**, I **was**.	4.mp3
5.**Where** were you at **ten** o'**clock**?	5.mp3
6.I was in a **café** with **friends**.	6.mp3
7.Were you **there** all **morning**?	7.mp3
8.**No**, we **weren't**. We were **there** for an **hour**.	8.mp3

Famous ex-teachers: Activity 1

Read and listen to the text. Choose the correct answers.

Famous ex-teachers Everybody knows that before she was a famous author, J.K. Rowling was an English teacher at a language institute in Portugal.	Activity 1.MP3

But here are four more ex-teachers. Maybe you know them... The American author, Stephen King, is famous for his horror stories and the films made from his books. *Carrie*, *The Shining*, and *The Shawshank Redemption* were all novels by Stephen King. But, after university, his first job was as an English teacher at Hampden Academy, a public high school in Maine, USA. British guitarist, Brian May, was in one of the greatest rock bands ever: Queen. But before the band was famous, he was a maths teacher in South London. He says he was happy with his job but the students were sometimes difficult. American actor, Sylvester Stallone, famous for the *Rocky* and *Rambo* films, was at drama school in Switzerland in the 1960s. He needed some money, so he worked as a PE teacher when he was a drama student. Finally, Australian actor, Hugh Jackman, wasn't a teacher, but before he went to drama school, he was a teaching assistant at Uppingham School in England. He was there for a year. Today he is famous as Wolverine in the *X-Men* films and as Jean Valjean in *Les Miserables*.	

1. Which famous person was a teacher in a foreign country?

    - J.K.Rowling
    - Stephen King
    - Brian May

2. Which famous person was a student and a teacher at the same time?

    - Sylvester Stallone
    - Hugh Jackman
    - J.K. Rowling

3. Which famous person was in England for a year?

    - Hugh Jackman
    - Stephen King
    - Brian May

4. Which famous person was good at music and numbers?

    - Brian May
    - J.K. Rowling
    - Sylvester Stallone

5. Which famous person was a teacher in his/her country before he/she was a writer?

- Stephen King
- Brian May
- Hugh Jackman

Famous ex-teachers: Activity 2

Read the text again. Choose *True* or *False*.

Famous ex-teachers

Everybody knows that before she was a famous author, J.K. Rowling was an English teacher at a language institute in Portugal.

But here are four more ex-teachers. Maybe you know them...

The American author, Stephen King, is famous for his horror stories and the films made from his books. *Carrie*, *The Shining*, and *The Shawshank Redemption* were all novels by Stephen King. But, after university, his first job was as an English teacher at Hampden Academy, a public high school in Maine, USA.

British guitarist, Brian May, was in one of the greatest rock bands ever: Queen. But before the band was famous, he was a maths teacher in South London. He says he was happy with his job but the students were sometimes difficult.

American actor, Sylvester Stallone, famous for the *Rocky* and *Rambo* films, was at drama school in Switzerland in the 1960s. He needed some money, so he worked as a PE teacher when he was a drama student.

Finally, Australian actor, Hugh Jackman, wasn't a teacher, but before he went to drama school, he was a teaching assistant at Uppingham School in England. He was there for a year. Today he is famous as Wolverine in the *X-Men* films and as Jean Valjean in *Les Miserables*.

1. J.K. Rowling was an English teacher.
   - True
   - False
2. Stephen King writes funny stories.
   - True
   - False
3. Brian May was a music teacher.
   - True

- False

4. Sylvester Stallone lived in Switzerland.

    - True
    - False

5. Hugh Jackman was a teaching assistant in Australia.

    - True
    - False